FOR FOUNDERS AND ANGELS READING COMPS

Before you quote a round as a comp

Four checks, with three real deals from this week.



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I coach founders.

1

First, find the priced part.

Shield AI's $2.5B headline is three pieces.



$1B Series H at $28.8B post-money

The valuation is attached to this slice.

$1B structured equity from Blackstone funds

A different instrument from the Series H.

$500M debt led by JPMorgan

Debt is repaid. It is not ownership.

$2.5B headline, $1B Series H

Shield AI announcement, November 5, 2026. Breakdown per Dealroom

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2

Second, check who got the money.

A bigger price does not mean the company raised.

Revolut's $115B sale brought no new money

Buyers bought existing shares from holders.

The price is up 53% on the prior sale

A secondary shows what buyers pay today.



Ask how much stock was sold

Revolut declined to say.

Price is not proceeds

TechCrunch, November 4, 2026

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THIRD, READ THE BUYER TOO

0.5%

Dropbox revenue growth.

Same release, $350M cash for Tigris.

An exit price reflects the buyer's need as much as the target's results.

Read the buyer's quarter

Dropbox Q3 2026 earnings release, 8-K Exhibit 99.1, November 5, 2026 (sec.gov)

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4

Finally, write the round in one line.

What is priced

$1B Series H at $28.8B post-money.

What is not

$1B structured equity and $500M debt.

Who received the money

The company, or the existing holders.

Quote the line, not just the valuation

Shield AI announcement, November 5, 2026. Breakdown per Dealroom



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Quote the instrument, not just the price.

Priced, unpriced, and who got paid.
Three columns in every comp sheet.

Repost for a founder reading comps



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